Alice Waters of Chez Panisse restaurant in California writes, "young turnips with their greens are in the markets in spring and fall. Together they make a delicious soup."

turnip soup

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 40 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

2 bunches of young turnips with greens, about 1½lb (675g) total in weight
3 tbsp butter or olive oil
1 onion, thinly sliced
1 bay leaf
2 sprigs of thyme
sea salt
1¼ quarts (1¼ liters) well-flavored chicken stock

1 Remove the greens from the turnips, then trim and discard the stems. Rinse and drain the leaves and cut into ½in (1cm) strips. Trim the roots from the bases and, if the skins are tough (taste one to see), peel before slicing thinly. Heat the butter or oil in a heavy pot over low heat, add the onion, and cook very gently for 12 minutes or until soft.

2 Stir in the turnip bases, along with the bay leaf and thyme, and season with salt. Cook for 5 minutes, stirring occasionally, then pour in the stock and bring to a boil. Lower the heat to a simmer, cover, and cook for 10 minutes. Add the turnip greens and cook for another 5–10 minutes or until tender. Remove the bay leaf, check the seasoning, and serve. This is excellent with a little grated Parmesan on top.